

LEC10 - Race and Ethnicity

Social Construction

- The view that elements of our social world including characteristics such as race, gender, and sexuality are products of particular social and historical contents and upheld by people and institutions
 - Affected by geography and time
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Race and Ethnicity

Race: A characterization based on someone's physical traits, such as skin colour and hair texture, and occasionally based on knowledge of ancestry

- Physical traits shape identity, interactions, and experience in the world
- Can create boundaries between groups

Ethnicity: Shared culture, ancestry, and history which may also include shared language and religion

- Most common reported ethnicities shift is from immigration, the nature of reporting (number of write in options given, examples provided in the census)
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A Social Construct With Real Implications

Prejudice: An attitude that negatively judges people based on their group membership

Discrimination: Negative actions against a group of people based on their group membership

Status Cues: Visual indicators of a person's social position

Examples

- The findings of various audit studies
- Red-lining
- Hate crimes
- Implicit bias
- Systemic racism
- Immigration policies
 - Immigrants of specific backgrounds were treated different than other races even though they were brought in to contribute to the country
- Canada's treatment of indigenous peoples
- Settlement in Canada

White privilege

- The world white is not equivalent to visible minorities, or “not white”
 - A categorization based on someone’s physical traits, such as skin color and hair texture, and occasionally based on knowledge of ancestry
 - Racial category
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Audit Studies

- Public transit in Australia
 - Riders of different races, different neighborhoods, different drivers, variation in attire
 - Patterns
 - Researchers pretend do not have enough money to ride, while varying things like race
 - Found preferential treatment
- Labour market and criminal record
- Labour market in Canada
- Rental housing market in Toronto